



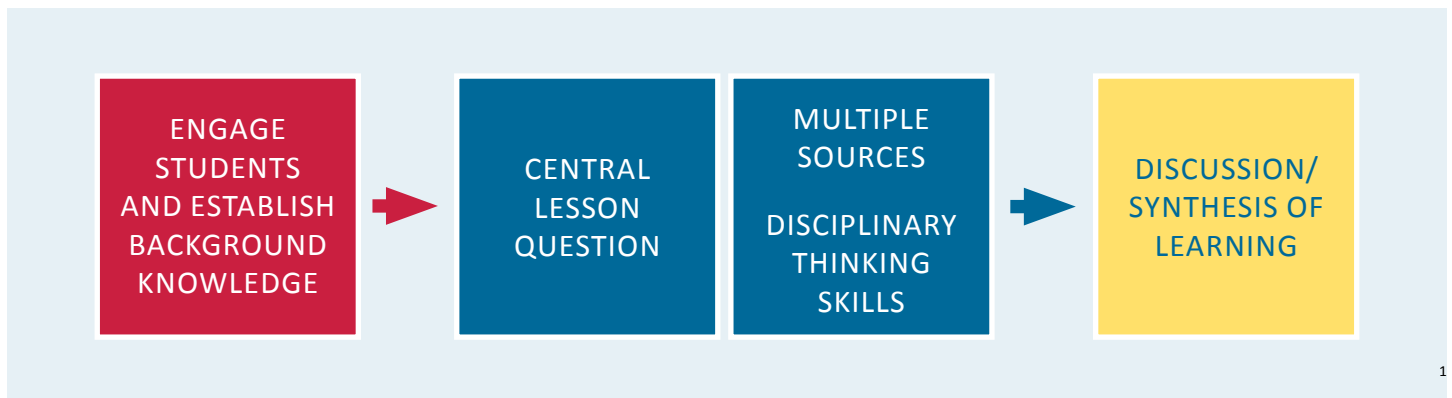
PURPOSE:

This checklist is intended for educators to use when selecting supplemental lesson materials for classroom instruction, or to evaluate educator-created instructional materials. This checklist focuses on best practices for inquiry-driven instruction in social studies courses and is not intended to be used as an evaluation tool for educators. This checklist can be used to facilitate dialogue about lesson plans between educators and administrators. This checklist should serve as a support to guide educators, administrators, coaches, and instructional leaders in identifying high-quality social studies instruction and improving implementation of [OSSE's Social Studies Standards](#). The supplemental lesson rubric focuses on lesson design specific to social studies practice.

SUPPLEMENTARY INSTRUCTIONAL MATERIALS:

materials used to reinforce, enrich, or enhance instruction driven by core instructional material.

SUGGESTED STRUCTURE OF A SOCIAL STUDIES LESSON:



The components above may take place over several successive class periods, and each component correlates to some elements of the rubric below. In general, establishing background knowledge connects to the introduction of any learning activity. The Central Lesson Question contributes to the Inquiry focus of the lesson, and the sections of the rubric entitled Focus on Disciplinary Reading, Thinking and Reasoning, Representation and Historical Agency, Lessons Scaffolded for Student Success can be evaluated by considering the source sets or student facing materials included in lesson materials.

This checklist is intended for use in evaluating supplemental lessons; however, this is not an exhaustive list for social studies instructional outcomes. Extended projects such as National History Day, Civic Action Projects, and other similar programs that are aligned with the OSSE Social Studies Standards and that support students in building their civic and historical efficacy skills may not be reflected in the rubric below.

DIRECTIONS:

Users should use the rubric below to evaluate proposed assessment tasks. Following the initial evaluation of assessment tasks, reviewers should determine if the assessment:

- Meets expectations - All the indicators below are met by the lesson plan.
- Partially meets expectations - Most of the indicators are met by the lesson plan.
- Does not meet expectations - Less than 50 percent of the indicators are met by the lesson plan **or** the lesson plan does not meet the **Standards Alignment** or **Representation and Historical Agency** criterion.

If the assessment does not meet expectations, the local education agency (LEA) or educator should identify an alternate lesson plan that is aligned to the expectations set forth by the social studies standards. If the lesson partially meets expectations, the reviewer should consider what changes need to be made to ensure the lesson plan represents a high-quality instructional experience for students.

1 Graphic adapted from Professor Abby Reisman, associate professor of Teacher Education in the Teaching, Learning, and Leadership Division at University of Pennsylvania, Graduate School of Education.

HIGH-QUALITY INSTRUCTIONAL MATERIALS CHECKLIST

Criterion for Success	Indicators
Standards Alignment	☐ The lesson materials align clearly to both the content and skills expectations articulated by the grade level standards in the OSSE Social Studies Standards .
Inquiry Focus	☐ Lesson materials are structured around a central question that elicits instructional tension between several legitimate civic, historical, economic or geographic perspectives or interpretations. ☐ The central lesson question and the majority of supporting questions necessitate evaluative rather than factual responses. ☐ The lesson question provides opportunities for students to apply a critical lens to the past and/ or present. ☐ The question is accessible, narrow in scope, and answerable using the materials and evidence provided during instruction. ☐ Lesson materials are centered on opportunities for students to evaluate the utility of different sources of information for answering a central question.
Lesson Framing and Contextualization	☐ Lesson materials provide students with sufficient background knowledge for interpreting and analyzing the central lesson question. This can be through direct instruction, background readings, or similar didactic lesson materials. ☐ Historical content provided is <i>in service of</i> supporting skill-based, student-centered instruction. ☐ Developing background knowledge facilitates student engagement in critical inquiry and comprises a small component (less than 15 percent) of the learning time.
Focus on Disciplinary Reading, Thinking and Reasoning.	☐ Students have opportunities to assess the utility and limitations of primary and/ or secondary texts through historical thinking skills such as sourcing, corroboration, close reading, and/or contextualization of evidence. ☐ Source materials contain clear information about the circumstances in which it was created through headnotes or footnotes. ☐ Source analysis moves beyond text comprehension and summarizing informational texts into evaluation and analysis of information utility. Source Set Considerations: ☐ Each source should provide additional nuance or a contrasting perspective in evaluating the central lesson question. ☐ Each source should include easily accessible information about the circumstances in which it was created. Note that this information should move beyond the name of the author and date in which the document was created, and should include information about the author and circumstances of creation that can help a student make determinations about reliability.
Representation and Historical Agency	☐ Students have opportunities to analyze a diversity of perspectives, voices, and narratives. ☐ Individuals within the lesson are represented as having agency in their own decision making and actions, and individuals are presented with dignity. ☐ Students have opportunities to question historical narratives and build their own interpretations of the past and present grounded in valid critical analysis of available information. ☐ Instruction does not promote inaccurate and harmful stereotypes or engage students in harmful learning experiences, including simulations. ☐ Materials utilize historically accurate terminology to describe the past. ☐ When applicable, lesson questions do not provide space for students to justify historical atrocities.
Lessons Scaffolded for Student Success	☐ Source material is accessible, and grade-level appropriate in both Lexile level and length. (Note: Sources may be modified and excerpted; however, modifications and excerpts retain the original intention of the document.) ☐ Materials utilize appropriate graphic organizers and guiding questions to support student analysis. Scaffolds prompt students to demonstrate cognition about information utility. ☐ Materials utilize appropriate social studies instructional strategies to accommodate student learning needs. ☐ Materials can be easily adapted or differentiated to support student learning needs.
Student Discourse, Voice and Agency	☐ Materials promote authentic discourse that enables students to practice disciplinary thinking, reasoning, and reading. ☐ Materials provide students with opportunities to participate in complex collaborative discussions, weighing multiple perspectives and a range of evidence. ☐ Students are supported in becoming responsible for the majority of the cognitive analysis during the course of the lesson.

SUPPLEMENTAL LESSON PLANNING CONVERSATION CHECKLIST:

The checklist above is intended for use by educators in evaluating supplemental curricular opportunities. However, some LEAs may wish to use this checklist to facilitate planning conversations around lesson creation. The supplemental resource below provides support for coaches in supporting educators to develop rigorous learning experiences. This conversation tool is best used in partnership with the **social studies walkthrough tool**.

Criterion for Success	Indicators	Planning Questions
Standards Alignment	The lesson materials align clearly to both the content and skills expectations articulated by the grade level standards in the OSSE Social Studies Standards.	n/a
Inquiry Focus	- Lesson materials are structured around a central question that elicits instructional tension between several legitimate civic, historical, economic or geographic perspectives or interpretations. - The central lesson question and the majority of supporting questions necessitate evaluative rather than factual responses. - The lesson question provides opportunities for students to apply a critical lens to the past and/ or present. - The question is accessible, narrow in scope, and answerable using the materials and evidence provided during instruction. - Lesson materials are centered on opportunities for students to evaluate the utility of different sources of information for answering a central question.	- What are the different possible answers for the central lesson question? - How does each component of the lesson help students engage with the problem space or differing interpretations of the central lesson question? - What, if any, changes need to be made to the central lesson question to make it more accessible for students? - Which, if any, components of the lesson do not contribute to the central inquiry?
Lesson Framing and Contextualization	- Lesson materials provide students with sufficient background knowledge for interpreting and analyzing the central lesson question. This can be through direct instruction, background readings, or similar didactic lesson materials. - Historical content provided is <i>in service of</i> supporting skill-based, student-centered instruction. - Developing background knowledge facilitates student engagement in critical inquiry and comprises a small component (less than 15 percent) of the learning time.	- How can you engage students during the lesson framing without unnecessarily prolonging this portion of the lesson? - Some examples: Quick “agree/disagree” prompts, student note catchers, initial hypothesizing. - How does each component of your lesson frame contribute to students’ ability to unpack the central lesson question or problem space? - Which parts of the lesson framing can be cut or simplified? - Does the lesson framing support students in understanding necessary background information for engaging in historical, civic or geographic analysis while leaving the majority of the cognitive analysis to students?

Criterion for Success	Indicators	Planning Questions
Focus on Disciplinary Reading, Thinking, and Reasoning.	- Students have opportunities to assess the utility and limitations of primary and/or secondary texts through historical thinking skills such as sourcing, corroboration, close reading and/or contextualization of evidence. - Source analysis moves beyond text comprehension and summarizing informational texts into evaluation and analysis of information utility.	- Where in the lesson are students explicitly asked about the reliability or utility of each piece of evidence? - How does evaluating the reliability of evidence contribute to student learning outcomes? - Which questions will you ask students to assess their understanding of each source's utility? - Are formative tasks focused on analysis and interpretation rather than summary and/or restating main ideas?
	Source Set Considerations: - Each source should provide additional nuance or a contrasting perspective in evaluating the central lesson question. - Each source should include easily accessible information about the circumstances in which it was created through a headnote or a footnote. - Note that this information should move beyond the name of the author and date in which the document was created and should include information about the author and circumstances of creation that can help a student make determinations about reliability.	- Are there sources that can be shortened or removed without losing historical nuance? - How can we ensure students are attending to the sourcing information? - If students are analyzing or annotating source material, are the annotations and analysis focused on critical analysis of the central lesson question? - If the source material is providing background information to foreground analysis, how can we ensure students are able to quickly comprehend the material and move quickly into the analysis portion of the learning experience?
Representation and Historical Agency	- Students have opportunities to analyze a diversity of perspectives, voices, and narratives when possible. - Individuals within the lesson are represented as having agency in their own decision making and actions, and individuals are presented with dignity. - Students have opportunities to question historical narratives and build their own interpretations of the past and present grounded in valid critical analysis of available information. - Instruction does not promote stereotypes or engage students in harmful learning experiences, including simulations.¹ - Materials utilize historically accurate terminology to describe the past.² - When applicable, lesson questions do not provide space for students to justify historical atrocities.	- What connection can students make between the lesson materials and their current context? - How can students engage in productive discourse about whose perspectives are represented and whose perspectives are missing? - Where in the lesson are students provided with the greatest agency over civic, geographic or historical interpretations?

Criterion for Success	Indicators	Planning Questions
Lessons Scaffolded for Student Success	- Source material is accessible, and grade-level appropriate in both Lexile level and length. (Note: sources may be modified and excerpted, however modifications and excerpts retain the original intention of the document.) - Materials utilize appropriate graphic organizers and guiding questions to support student analysis. Scaffolds prompt students to demonstrate cognition about information utility. - Materials utilize appropriate social studies instructional strategies to accommodate student learning needs. - Materials can be easily adapted or differentiated to support student learning needs.	- What scaffolds do students need to comprehend the source material available? - Do the sources need to be further modified? - How can you ensure reading comprehension is not a barrier to critical student engagement with the central lesson question? - How can this resource be adapted or differentiated for different student needs?
Student Discourse, Voice, and Agency	- Materials promote authentic discourse that enables students to practice disciplinary thinking, reasoning, and reading. - Materials provide students with opportunities to participate in complex collaborative discussions, weighing multiple perspectives and a range of evidence. - Students are supported in becoming responsible for the majority of the cognitive analysis during the course of the lesson.	- What questions can you use to engage students in disciplinary reasoning? - What questions can you use in formative discourse to prompt students to critically evaluate the utility of information? - How will you structure summative discourse? - What questions can you use to scaffold student discourse around the central lesson question?

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ENDNOTES:

1. Harmful instructional practices refer to practices including role play, simulations, and other instructional practices that trivialize the experiences of historical individuals, distort reality, disconnect historical atrocities from their context or create one-dimensional representations of complex historical moments.
For further reading on appropriate curricular choices see below:
 - [Southern Poverty Law Center: Ending Curriculum Violence](#)
 - [Echoes and Reflections: Why Simulation Activities Should Not Be Used](#)
2. Historically Accurate Terminology
The following terminology list from the Great Lakes Center for Equity [Assessing Bias in Standards and Curricular Materials](#) is not an exhaustive list of appropriate historical terminology, however it may serve as bench mark for discussing this portion of the walkthrough tool.
 - Curricular materials avoid using language such as “roaming”, “wandering”, or “roving” to describe the travel of the Indigenous People of the United States.
 - The text avoids using language that suggests groups of people were order-less or uncivilized than Euro-Americans.
 - The text avoids using language that suggests specific groups of people needing “saving” or “help.”
 - Standards describes groups of people in such a way as to counter stereotypes, bias, and marginalization.